Fire Drills and Evacuation Training

Illustrative content

This document is an illustrative paraphrase prepared for a demonstration project. It is not legal text; always follow the current rules issued by the local fire authority.

Drill frequency

A full-building evacuation (mock) drill is conducted at least twice a year, about six months apart. At least one drill each year is held without advance notice to occupants.

New tenants join the next scheduled drill; floor wardens are trained before their first drill.

Warden and occupant roles

Floor wardens sweep their floor, check washrooms and meeting rooms, and report "floor clear" to the command centre. Occupants use the nearest staircase, never the lifts, and gather at the assembly point for a headcount.

Evacuation time target

The building is expected to be fully evacuated within the time set in the approved evacuation plan. Each drill records the time from the start of the drill to the last person out, and the headcount.

Records to keep

Keep a drill register with the date, time, evacuation time, headcount, observations and corrective actions. Inspectors may ask to see the drill register (see REG-FIRE-001).

After the drill

Hold a debrief within one week, assign each corrective action an owner and a due date, and raise work orders for any defects found during the drill (for example a door that did not release).